

# Verb Concept Grids II — SAYING / COMMUNICATION

Round-2 instrument, built to the revised method of [\(phase4-triage-2026-06.md\)](#) §7.2. Single concept, sub-divided; predictions range over the compositional machinery (frame × concord shape × aspect × stem lexical aspect, plus the matrix-particle layer), not over reading-cells. Phase 3 remains Mat's solo translation session; each sub-category closes with the five-line block before moving on. A MOTION make-up batch rides along at the end.

Why SAYING is now higher-value than its original deferral score. It was deferred because it "adds no column the six don't already test." That was true of the cell grid. Under the revised machinery view, SAYING is the natural stress test for three of the June discoveries at once: it is the predicted home of a **reportative matrix particle** (the *dizque* slot), the predicted home of a **grammaticalized quotative** (GA *be like* / *go* / *be all* are exactly the kind of high-frequency colloquial matrix material the language has been recruiting), and a rich supply of deverbal nominals (*the chats*, *the gossip*) that lets battery **B1 (do-support)** run inside the session instead of separately.

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## How to use this document

1. Work the sub-categories **in priority order** (Core before Optional). The MOTION skip happened because everything was nominally equal priority; this document ranks instead.
2. For each sub-category: read the prediction table, translate the pairs, then **immediately** fill the closing block before starting the next sub-category (discoveries cascade; capture them in order).
3. Prediction tables are claims to test, not commitments. Mark ✓ / ✗ / ~ against each row inline.
4. Phonological or orthographic discoveries: flag with [\[New rule needed: ...\]](#) and move on.
5. Embedded batteries (B1, B3, B5-partial, B6-partial) are marked ◆ — these double as triage-doc deliverables.

Closing block template (copy under each sub-category):

**Cluster verdict:** concept-cohesive / splinters by verb / absorbed by grammar **Carve**  
**decision:** keep cognate / merge / split / coin / interjection-ize / grammar-only  
**Machinery results:** which frame×shape×aspect predictions held, failed, reframed  
**Surprises: Destinations:**

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## Phase 0' — Sub-category inventory

SAYING decomposes into seven territories with different predicted fates:

| # | Sub-category           | GA territory                                                      | Priority                                          |
|---|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| A | Bare utterance         | <i>say, tell, talk, speak, blurt, let slip</i>                    | Core                                              |
| B | Reportative edge       | <i>they say, I heard, word is, sounds like, supposedly</i>        | Core                                              |
| C | Quotation              | <i>be like, go, be all; direct vs indirect speech</i>             | Core                                              |
| G | Interactive / durative | <i>chat, discuss, argue, gossip</i>                               | Core (hosts ♦B1)                                  |
| E | Speech acts            | <i>ask, answer, promise, warn, thank, apologize, greet</i>        | Optional                                          |
| F | Channel                | <i>call, text, write, message, reach out, hit up, drop a line</i> | Optional (extends existing <i>rhiitso, rhũĩ</i> ) |
| D | Manner of speaking     | <i>whisper, shout, yell, mumble, mutter</i>                       | Optional                                          |

## A — Bare utterance [Core]

**Scope.** Saying as such; speech directed at a recipient; speech as activity.

**Predictions.**

| Machinery                    | Prediction                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Frame default                | Volitive — speech is canonically deliberate; go-ahead is the unmarked frame for say.                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| get-oneself + utterance verb | <b>The PH reading of saying = GA <i>blurt</i> / <i>let slip</i> territory.</b> Predict the frame absorbs that lexicon: <i>blurt out</i> , <i>let slip</i> , <i>it slipped out</i> do not survive as verbs; "got myself saying it" carries the meaning. The sharpest lexical-absorption prediction of the session. |
| Concord shapes               | Infinitive-shaped = threshold ("finally got myself to say it" — effortful confession); progressive-shaped = caught-mid-speech; passive-shaped (- <i>opw</i> -class) = ? — first test of the passive shape outside MOTION. ♦ feeds §4.2 drafting.                                                                  |
| tell                         | <b>Reduces to the possession-causative.</b> <i>Tell her the news</i> = give-extension with an information possessum (the <i>ritm</i> pattern). Test whether the topic-marked-definite-object restriction (triage §2.4, B7) recurs with abstract objects. ♦B7-adjacent.                                            |
| talk/speak                   | Durative activities: imperfect-natural, PS-rich, REC-nominal-capable ( <i>the talks</i> ).                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Lexical fates                | <i>say</i> survives as the core verb; <i>tell</i> grammar-absorbed (prediction above); <i>speaking</i> / <i>talk</i> merge or register-split.                                                                                                                                                                     |

### Contrastive pairs.

- (a) "I said it." (b) "It slipped out / I blurted it out." *Tests the blurt-absorption prediction: does (b) need any lexical verb beyond say under get-oneself?*
- (a) "I finally said it." (b) "I was saying it when she walked in." *Tests infinitive-shaped (threshold confession) vs progressive-shaped concord on one stem.*
- (a) "I told her the news." (b) "You know the news — I told her." *Tests tell-as-possession-causative, and the definite-object restriction with an abstract possessum.*
- (a) "We talked for hours." (b) "I spoke with the manager." *Tests talk/speak: one verb register-split, or two? Reciprocity flag — see G.*

**Watch for.** If (1b) works frame-only, record which GA blurt-class verbs die; that is a settled-dust finding of the same type as PERCEPTION-PH.

**Closing block:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Scope.** Hearsay and secondhand information. The headline prediction: a **reportative matrix particle** — the conlang's *dizque*.

**Candidate etyma** (apply the membership criterion: finite verb in the etymon → tense-capable):

| GA source                     | Candidate?      | Notes                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>they say (that)</i>        | yes             | Generic 3PL — person syncretism comes pre-installed, the best-formed candidate.                                                                                                           |
| <i>I heard (that)</i>         | yes             | Source is already past-tense — does the particle lexicalize the past form, and what is its non-past partner ( <i>I hear...</i> )? Interesting tense-pair asymmetry vs <i>enp/enniip</i> . |
| <i>(it) sounds like</i>       | yes             | Auditory-inferential rather than pure hearsay — may pair with <i>piies</i> (visual-inferential) rather than with the reportatives.                                                        |
| <i>word is (that)</i>         | yes<br>(copula) | Marginal finite verb; good edge-test of the membership criterion itself.                                                                                                                  |
| <i>supposedly, apparently</i> | <b>no</b>       | No finite verb → modal adverbs (the <i>meiyi/bauyiis</i> layer), not matrix particles. Confirm they pattern as adverbs.                                                                   |

**Predictions.**

| Machinery           | Prediction                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tense               | Each surviving particle shows the privative non-past/past pair (cf. <i>enp/enniip</i> , <i>no/nii</i> ); test with "always" / "tomorrow, probably" adverbs per the settled <i>enp</i> method. ♦B3 method also applies to <i>piies</i> here — close that battery.                                                                                                                              |
| Government          | Unknown — assign each new particle a government class (imperfect-forcing like <i>enp</i> , or free like <i>no</i> ). ♦B5.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Ordering & stacking | topic particle > matrix particle > clause; test reportative stacking over <i>enp</i> ("I heard it ended up...") and under matrix <i>no</i> ("I know they say..."). Pronominal buffering expected at depth 2+. ♦B6-partial.                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Evidential system   | <b>A three-legged matrix evidential layer may be emerging:</b> <i>no</i> (knowledge), <i>piies</i> (appearance/inference), reportative (hearsay). If <i>sounds like</i> survives separately, the appearance leg splits by modality (visual <i>piies</i> vs auditory), with the <i>hiie/nou</i> topic-particle choice doing further evidential work underneath — extend the seem/look finding. |
| Lexical fates       | GA <i>hear</i> the perception verb is already covered by <i>nous/not</i> ; the reportative <i>heard (that)</i> is predicted to split off into the particle, mirroring the <i>no(topic)/no(matrix)</i> homophone pattern.                                                                                                                                                                      |

### Contrastive pairs.

5. (a) "They say the bridge is out." (b) "I heard the bridge is out." *Two reportative sources, one proposition: do both survive, and do they contrast (general hearsay vs personal source)?*
6. (a) "Apparently she left." (b) "I heard she ended up leaving." *\*Adverb-layer vs particle-layer; and reportative-over-\*enniip stacking.*
7. (a) "It sounds like rain." (b) "It looks like rain." *Auditory vs visual inference: does sounds-like join piies as a modal-of-evidence pair, and which topic particle does each select?*
8. (a) "Word is they're hiring." — *edge-test of the membership criterion.*

**Watch for.** Whether reportatives embed the clause's aspect freely or govern it; and whether the personal-source reportative (*I heard*) resists person syncretism (its etymon is 1SG-specific — does a "you heard / she heard" reading survive anywhere?).

Closing block: \_\_\_\_\_

**Scope.** Framing reported speech and thought. Second headline prediction: a **grammaticalized quotative particle** from GA colloquial *be like* / *go* / *be all*.

## Predictions.

| Machinery          | Prediction                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Source selection   | <i>be like</i> is the highest-frequency GA colloquial quotative and the predicted winner; <i>go</i> and <i>be all</i> may leave register-marked or fossilized residue.                                                                                                         |
| Architecture       | Since aspect lives on weak pronouns, the quotative is predicted to be an <b>aspect-less particle</b> hosted by the pronoun: roughly e [QUOT] "... — with the pronoun's aspect fusion supplying was-like vs is-like. Clean test of the split-TAM architecture in new territory. |
| Coverage           | GA <i>be like</i> quotes speech <b>and</b> stance/internal reaction. Predict the quotative inherits both — overlapping COGNITION residue (a quotable-thought strategy alongside <i>pau</i> , <i>klik</i> ).                                                                    |
| Direct vs indirect | Predict direct quotation = quotative particle; indirect = matrix <i>no</i> / reportative layer. If so, the direct/indirect distinction is carried entirely by particle choice — no complementizer needed.                                                                      |
| Syntax             | Where does quoted material sit relative to topic structure? Can a quote be topicalized ("..." — <i>that's what she was like</i> )? Expect right-periphery behavior; check against the antitopic <i>on-X-end</i> pattern.                                                       |

## Contrastive pairs.

9. (a) "She was like, 'no way.'" (b) "She said no." *Quotative vs plain say\**: register, directness, or both?\*
10. (a) "I was like, finally!" (internal reaction, nothing uttered) (b) "I said 'finally.'" *Tests stance-quotation inheritance.*
11. (a) "He goes, 'who, me?'" (b) "He was all, 'who, me?'" *Do go and be all survive at all, and with what register color?*
12. (a) She said (that) she'd come. (b) She was like, "I'll come." *Indirect vs direct: particle choice as the whole distinction?*

**Watch for.** The quotative's tense/aspect locus. If the pronoun carries it, that is strong confirmation of split-TAM; if the quotative itself inflects, it may be a matrix particle instead (etymon *was like* contains a finite verb — the membership criterion cuts both ways here, and the outcome decides the analysis).

**Closing block:** \_\_\_\_\_

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## G — Interactive / durative [Core] ♦B1 host

**Scope.** Two-or-more-party speech activities: chat, discuss, argue, gossip. Chosen Core because it hosts the do-support battery on home turf.

### Predictions.

| Machinery               | Prediction                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Aspect profile          | Activities: imperfect-natural; perfect get-oneself = "ended up in an argument" (PH-flavored).                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| REC-ITER nominals       | Rich: <i>the chats, the gossip(ings), the arguments</i> . ♦B1 runs here: get-oneself + deverbal REC-nominal with and without <i>ię</i> ; go-ahead + nominal with and without <i>with</i> . Four-cell battery, two nominals minimum.                                                                                      |
| Possession construction | "We had a chat / got ourselves a chat" — does the possession construction host speech-event nominals as plain possessa (bare nominal, no <i>ię</i> )? If yes, the <i>ię</i> requirement may track <i>activity-engagement</i> vs <i>event-possession</i> , which would sharpen the triage §2.1 residue spec considerably. |
| Reciprocity             | <b>New gap:</b> how is mutual action marked? GA <i>each other</i> fate unknown; <i>we</i> -subject may carry reciprocity unmarked; or a comitative strategy ( <i>with</i> -phrase) emerges. First data point for a reciprocal section.                                                                                   |
| Stimulus-promotion      | "It got us arguing" — strategy reuse outside the stative domain; checks whether the strategies are stative-only or general.                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Lexical fates           | <i>gossip</i> likely survives (salient nominal + activity); <i>discuss</i> may lose to <i>talk-about</i> ; <i>argue</i> survives.                                                                                                                                                                                        |

### Contrastive pairs.

13. (a) "We were chatting all evening." (b) "We got to chatting." (c) "the chats" (shared-knowledge routine). *Aspect spread on one stem, then the REC nominal — then run ♦B1 on (c)'s nominal in all four cells.*
14. (a) "We argued about money." (b) "Money got us arguing." *Reciprocal expression + stimulus-promotion outside statives.*
15. (a) "They gossip about everyone." (b) "the gossip(ings)." *Habitual frame + REC-ITER; second ♦B1 nominal.*

**Watch for.** Any reciprocal marking at all; and whether B1 splits *ię*-requiring activity-nominals from bare event-possessa.

**Closing block:** \_\_\_\_\_

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## E — Speech acts [Optional]

**Scope.** Performatives and conventionalized acts: ask, answer, promise, warn, thank, apologize, greet.

### Predictions.

| Machinery      | Prediction                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Frame affinity | Strongly volitive — performatives are the most deliberate speech there is. The get-oneself frame on a performative is predicted <b>grammatical but attitudinally loaded</b> : "ended up promising / got myself promising" = the commitment-trap reading (reluctance, social pressure). Attitudinal gold; the DOING attitudinal finding should recur sharpened. |
| ask            | Interacts with the open content-question system and with ea. Embedding a polar question under ask ("asked whether...") may surface the first complementizer data — or ea may simply ride along into the embedded clause. High-information test.                                                                                                                |
| Formulaic acts | <i>thank, apologize, greet</i> predicted to <b>interjection-ize</b> , not survive as verbs: GA <i>thanks, my bad, sorry, hey</i> are the high-frequency colloquial sources (cf. existing <i>ohô, nóeie</i> interjection entries). Verbal uses ("I apologized") then route through quotative or activity strategies ("I was like, my bad").                     |
| warn           | Candidate for matrix-particle periphery ( <i>heads up (that)...</i> ? — no finite verb; predict adverb/interjection instead).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

### Contrastive pairs.

16. (a) "I promised." (b) "I ended up promising." *The commitment trap.*
17. (a) "She asked if I was coming." (b) "She asked, 'coming at all?'" *Indirect vs direct question embedding; ea behavior under ask\*.\**
18. (a) "I apologized to her." (b) "I was like, my bad." *Interjection-ization and the quotative workaround.*

Closing block: \_\_\_\_\_

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## F — Channel [Optional]

**Scope.** Medium-specific contact verbs. Extends existing entries *rhiitso* (< \**reach out*) and *rhiĩ* (< \**ring*).

### Predictions.



| Machinery       | Prediction                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Source register | GA colloquial idioms dominate: <i>hit (someone) up, shoot a text, drop a line</i> . Predict fused survivals like <i>pikkp</i> — and a test of whether <i>*up</i> is a productive satellite (an <i>up</i> -counterpart to <i>opw</i> ) or fuses only. ♦ extends B2's satellite question to a second particle. |
| Frame spread    | Volitive default; get-oneself = "ended up on the phone for an hour" (PH duration); possession construction for received messages ("got myself a text" — possession of a message-object, bare nominal predicted).                                                                                             |
| Lexical fates   | <i>call</i> territory: <i>rhiĩ</i> vs <i>rhiitso</i> division of labor to settle (medium-specific vs medium-neutral).                                                                                                                                                                                        |

### Contrastive pairs.

19. (a) "I'll hit her up." (b) "She hit me up out of nowhere." *Volitive vs PH on a fused idiom; watch the up element.*
20. (a) "I got a text." (b) "I got myself texting all night." *Possession (bare nominal) vs activity engagement (concord) — a B1-adjacent contrast with a non-deverbal nominal.*

Closing block: \_\_\_\_\_

## D — Manner of speaking [Optional]

**Scope.** whisper, shout, yell, mumble, mutter. Lexical-aspect playground; lowest priority because it mostly re-tests known machinery — but the cleanest place to watch **lexical aspect condition the concord shapes**, which the §4.2 rewrite needs examples of.

### Predictions.

| Machinery                | Prediction                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Semelfactive vs activity | <i>shout/yell</i> (semelfactive-capable) vs <i>mumble/mutter</i> (activity-only): predict the infinitive-shaped concord is natural on semelfactives and coerced on pure activities, and vice versa for the progressive shape. A two-by-two with named stems = the worked example §4.2 wants. |
| Stative interface        | "Pain made me scream" — activity-coercion output for internal states; checks strategy reuse alongside G's stimulus-promotion test.                                                                                                                                                           |
| Aesthetics               | Manner verbs are sound-symbolism carriers; flag any derivations with strong phonaesthetic results for <code>poetics.md</code> .                                                                                                                                                              |

## Contrastive pairs.

21. (a) "She shouted once." (b) "She was shouting for hours."  
22. (a) "He muttered something." (b) "He got himself muttering again."

Closing block: \_\_\_\_\_

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## MOTION make-up batch (carried from round 1)

Translate the four skipped pairs; same protocol, one closing block for the lot.

M2. (a) "Come here." (b) "Go there." — *deixis: lexical or speaker-anchored grammar?* M3. (a) "We were driving for hours." (b) "We set off at dawn." — *durative vs onset; onset now predicted = imperfect-tied inchoative machinery, re-test under the new analysis.* M4. (a) "Bring it to me." (b) "Take it there." — *caused-motion deixis; also a possession-causative candidate (bring = cause-to-have-here?).* M5. (a) "I take that walk every morning." (b) "the walks." — *third ♦B1 nominal, from the original star example.*

Closing block: \_\_\_\_\_

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## Session-level watch list

1. **Reportative matrix particle attested?** (B) — confirms the class is productive, not a three-member relic.
2. **Quotative particle attested, and where does its TAM live?** (C) — the decisive split-TAM test.
3. **Blurt-absorption** (A) — the PERCEPTION-PH pattern recurring in SAYING.
4. **tell = possession-causative?** (A) — if yes, the possession construction's reach extends to abstract transfer and the §2.4 section grows a subsection.
5. **B1 verdict** (G, + F20, M5) — *ię* as activity-engagement marker vs event-possession? Finalizes the REC-demotion residue spec before Session V drafting.
6. **Reciprocity gap** (G) — first data for an undescribed system.
7. **Interjection-ization of formulaic acts** (E) — feeds the dictionary's interjection layer.
8. **Evidential triangle** (B + round-1 *piies* findings) — if it holds, a new unified subsection: the matrix evidential layer.

## Phase 4' reconvene agenda

- Read closing blocks against the watch list; settle B1, B3, B5 (new-particle government classes), B6-partial, B7-adjacent.
- Carve decisions → recipe building-order entries; dictionary batch D4 (SAYING) scoped.
- Decide: does the matrix-particle section get drafted with three members + criteria, or wait for the reportative results? (Recommendation: draft after this session either way — the section's claims are testable-by-design.)
- Route new flags; update `phase4-triage-2026-06.md` §6 battery statuses; strike graduated items.

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*Versioning: 2026-06-11 — v1, drafted as the round-2 instrument per triage §7.2 revisions.*